

Feedback Analyst Findings: Customer Perspective on Product Images

Module 5 worked example

COURSE	AI Workshop 2.0, Desktop Edition
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YOU NEED	A Mac or PC and a paid Claude plan

Module 5 worked example

Date: 2025-11-27 **Agent:** Feedback Analyst (7 of 8) **Objective:** Analyse customer perspective on product images vs seller perspective

Executive Summary

Extensive peer-reviewed research and consumer studies reveal a **fundamental disconnect** between what sellers optimise for (short-term CTR) and what customers actually want (accurate representation, clean visuals, trust). The evidence strongly supports clean, professional imagery over cluttered, busy images.

Key Statistics

METRIC	FINDING	SOURCE
Photography reliance	75% of shoppers rely on product photography for purchase decisions	Retail Technology Review
Reviews impact	93% say reviews impact purchase decisions	PowerReviews 2023
User-generated trust	77% trust user-generated imagery	Nature/Humanities Communications
Subconscious decisions	95% of purchasing decisions made subconsciously	Harvard Business School
Image first attention	Product photos are ALWAYS first thing viewed	CXPartners Eye Tracking

Peer-Reviewed Research Findings

1. Eye Tracking Studies

Key Finding: Cluttered pages negatively impact shoppers

"M&S crammed too much information next to its product image - product name, price, product code, ratings and reviews, product description and availability. Furthermore, all the fonts are a similar size and there is not much white space between them. This section therefore looked cluttered and participants tended to ignore it."

"Participants preferred product descriptions to be in bullet points... for quick scanning."

Source: [CXPartners - Eye Tracking E-commerce Study](#)

Implication: Visual clutter causes shoppers to IGNORE information, not engage with it.

2. Product Image Impact Research

Key Finding: Consumers prefer specific image qualities

"Consumers prefer product photos with a larger key object, lower entropy on key objects, a warmer color, a higher contrast, a higher depth-of-field, and more social presences."

Source: [ResearchGate - Impact of Product Photo on Consumer Purchase Intention](#)

Translation:

- **Larger key object** = Clean, focused product (not cluttered)
- **Lower entropy** = Less visual noise/complexity
- **Higher depth-of-field** = Professional photography quality

3. Trust and Visual Content

Key Finding: Image quality directly creates trust

"An appealing image can create trust, particularly in e-commerce, where the customer cannot physically experience the product. Trust is a central influencing factor for purchasing decisions and promotes customer loyalty in the long term."

Source: [RenderThat - Visual Language and Buying Behavior](#)

"High-quality product images create trust, convey quality and arouse emotions. Studies show that visual content is processed faster than text."

4. Expectation-Confirmation Theory

Key Finding: Misleading images cause returns and dissatisfaction

"Despite its strategic advantages, e-commerce faces key challenges, including product-expectation mismatches, the lack of tactile shopping experiences, high return rates, and the accuracy of personalized recommendations."

"Post-purchase satisfaction is the sole significant predictor of return intention, with dissatisfaction driving returns."

Source: [ScienceDirect - Personalized E-commerce and Consumer Behavior](#)

Implication: Busy images with exaggerated claims create expectation gaps that drive returns.

5. The Expectation Gap Problem

Key Finding: Customers' expectations are frequently unmet

"For the majority of variables under study, a GAP exists, indicating that customers' expectations are not fully met by marketers."

"Customer satisfaction could take place when there is no discrepancy between expectations and performance."

Source: [ResearchGate - GAP Analysis Study](#)

Amazon-Specific Customer Complaints

"Not As Described" Issues

"Not As Described complaints on Amazon can result in listing removal, account suspension, or permanent consequences, often caused by discrepancies between product images, descriptions, or specifications."

Common image-related complaints:

- "Smaller than I expected"
- "Doesn't look like the picture"
- "Misleading packaging shown"
- "Features shown but not included"

Source: [Amazon Sellers Lawyer](#)

False Advertising Violations

"Common image violations include showing additional items in the main image that are NOT included, editing product images to make them look larger or more premium than they actually are, and using fake before-and-after images."

Source: [Marketplace Valet - False Advertising](#)

What Customers Actually Want

1. Accurate Representation

"Sellers should go beyond a single product shot and include multiple angles, lifestyle photos that show the product in real use, and 'what's in the box' images so there are no surprises."

2. Size Context

"Shoppers struggle with scale, so adding size comparison photos—like a water bottle next to a common household object—or overlaying dimensions directly on the image prevents the classic 'smaller than I expected' complaints."

3. Clean, Scannable Information

Eye tracking research consistently shows:

- Bullet points preferred over paragraphs
- White space improves comprehension
- Too many colors confuse users
- Cluttered sections get ignored

The Trust Hierarchy

What Builds Trust (Ranked):

1. **Customer photos in reviews** - 77% trust
2. **Professional product photography** - Creates quality perception
3. **Accurate representation** - Matches expectations
4. **Clear, uncluttered design** - Easy to process

What Destroys Trust:

1. **Misleading images** - Creates expectation gap
2. **Exaggerated claims** - Leads to disappointment
3. **Visual clutter** - Signals low quality
4. **Inconsistent branding** - Lacks professionalism

Customer vs Seller Perspective Gap

WHAT SELLERS OPTIMISE FOR	WHAT CUSTOMERS ACTUALLY VALUE
Click-through rate (CTR)	Accurate product representation
"Scroll-stopping" busy images	Clean, professional imagery
Feature callouts everywhere	Scannable bullet points
Badge/callout overlays	Trust signals (reviews, ratings)
Short-term conversion	Long-term brand trust
Standing out in search	Matching expectations

The Returns Problem

Expectation-Reality Gap Drives Returns

"Neither perceived value nor purchase intention significantly affects post-purchase satisfaction, revealing a gap between expectation and experience."

Impact of misleading images:

1. Customer clicks based on exaggerated image
2. Product arrives different from expectation
3. Customer returns product
4. Customer leaves negative review
5. Seller loses money + reputation

Better approach:

1. Clean, accurate image sets proper expectation
2. Product matches or exceeds expectation
3. Customer satisfied
4. Positive review
5. Long-term brand building

Academic Framework: E-Service Quality

Research identifies key dimensions affecting customer satisfaction:

1. **Website design** - Clean, professional appearance
2. **Security/privacy** - Trust signals
3. **Fulfillment** - Product matches expectations

"Data from an online survey of 355 Indonesian online consumers showed that three dimensions of e-service quality—website design, security/privacy, and fulfillment—affect overall e-service quality."

Source: [ScienceDirect - E-Service Quality Study](#)

Conclusion

The customer perspective is clear: **Clean, accurate, professional product images build trust and satisfaction.** Busy, cluttered, exaggerated images may get clicks but create:

1. Expectation gaps
2. Higher return rates
3. Negative reviews
4. Brand damage
5. Long-term revenue loss

The seller community's focus on "CTR hacks" ignores what actually drives customer satisfaction and long-term business success.

Sources

Peer-Reviewed Research

1. [Nature](#) - Factors Affecting Consumer Trust
2. [ResearchGate](#) - Product Photo Impact on Purchase Intention
3. [PMC](#) - Eye Tracking in Virtual Retail
4. [PMC](#) - Online Reviews and Purchasing Decisions
5. [ScienceDirect](#) - E-Service Quality
6. [ScienceDirect](#) - Eye Tracking Consumer Intentions
7. [ResearchGate](#) - GAP Analysis Study
8. [Taylor & Francis](#) - Online Retail Experience

Industry Research

9. [Retail Technology Review](#) - Photography Statistics
10. [PowerReviews](#) - Power of Reviews 2023
11. [CXPartners](#) - Eye Tracking E-commerce
12. [RenderThat](#) - Visual Language and Buying

Amazon-Specific

13. [Amazon Sellers Lawyer](#) - Not As Described
14. [Marketplace Valet](#) - False Advertising
15. [My Amazon Guy](#) - Negative Reviews

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